Miswander



Creator master plan for Brittney and John

A familiar place, taken apart. Someone you love, somewhere inside. A maze whose doors can lead to a useful object, a game, a dangerous mistake, or another piece of the truth.

Working design: 4 internal environments / 8 main doors each / 32 doors total. The player is not told the world count. Both puzzle versions share the same destinations, inventory rewards, and rescue story.

Includes the new premise, origin-specific surroundings, open and locked doors, A-H walkthroughs, optional routes, cutscenes, life loss, inventory, and purchase proposals. Unapproved additions are concrete design proposals for review. Miswander remains a screened working title, not certified legal clearance.

The other title image



Keep both images; use the blue portal as the lead

This earlier exploration includes visible elemental scenery. It is retained because both images were requested, not because it defines the final title-screen direction. The selected direction on page 1 uses gold lettering, a mysterious door, a blue portal swirl, and atmospheric maze passages.

Reading this plan

Pages 3-4: premise and origin identity. Pages 5-6: door rules, maze connections, life loss. Pages 7-18: the four environments, each with two door-catalogue pages and one route/cutscene page. Pages 19-20: inventory, crafting, and purchases. Page 21: finale and implementation checks.

Door IDs are creator-facing: K = Kiln, H = Harbor, F = Fair, O = Orchard. Players see illustrated markings, not numbered tasks. A-H labels describe eight walkthrough actions; they do not rename the eight doors. Door 4 is an optional branch in each environment.

A place that remembers you incorrectly

Someone you love disappears through an ordinary object. You follow them into a beautiful abandoned place. At first it looks unfamiliar. Then you find your kitchen chair sitting in a flooded corridor. A familiar song plays behind a locked door. Someone has been collecting pieces of people's lives.

What the place really is

The refuge began as a reconstruction of a family home after its builder lost his family. He expanded it by taking rooms, possessions, and eventually people and animals from elsewhere. He now calls himself the Warden. He insists he is keeping everyone safe, but changes the passages whenever anyone tries to leave. He cannot recreate the relationships that made his home meaningful.

The portal draws in a companion as part of one of these thefts; the player follows voluntarily. No Heart Lantern, love-powered portal engine, or repair-the-four-elements mission is required. The Warden initially helps because the player can reach broken sections and recover familiar objects. Each helpful instruction also teaches him more about the home he is trying to reproduce.

How the mystery unfolds

Kiln: a familiar object was here before you arrived. Harbor: records describe captives as replacements. Snowfair: the Warden has preserved the same evening repeatedly. Orchard: the original family room exposes who built this place and why. These discoveries are earned through doors, objects, and evidence rather than one introductory explanation.

Warmth and agency

Use a small interaction before the disappearance: a TV-night high-five, fetch with the dog, or a shared dinner joke. Repeat that detail as an altered clue. The companion leaves useful traces and operates the final lock from inside. Pip, a paper moth folded from discarded maps, brings warmth and optional hints; the Warden remains a person whose grief does not excuse captivity.

Core feeling: "I recognize this place, but it has been put together wrong." The environment gradually becomes more familiar as the player moves farther from home.

Three homes, one underlying maze

Chosen origin changes the remembered surroundings, sounds, companion traces, and portal opening. It does not change world names, required door rewards, puzzle answers, or the dependency graph. This keeps all three origins equally solvable.

CITY / upper-floor apartment

TV portal; child companion. Establish a buzzer intercom, apartment number, narrow kitchen, radiator, fire escape, neighboring windows, and traffic below. The sofa, remote, chair, wallpaper, and TV stand recur in impossible locations. City identity comes from density, stacked rooms, and shared-building sounds, not merely owning a television.

MIDWEST / farmhouse, barn, cornfield

Puddle portal; dog companion. Establish the screen porch, barn latch, grain chute, feed scoop, mudroom boots, wind across corn, and distant equipment. Recurrences include barn boards as bridges, corn growing inside rooms, the dog's blanket in a prize stall, and a feed bucket in a submerged archive.

SUBURBS / house, yard, garage

Dining-room mirror portal; partner companion. Establish a sliding patio door, fenced backyard, attached garage, staircase, porch light, and place settings. Recurrences include a sideways dining table, garage door used as a shutter, fence panels forming a pier, and the mirror framing an unfamiliar room.

Consistency rules for art and story

Choose three personal anchor props per origin and preserve their design across environments. Also carry one sound motif and one architectural feature. Alter location, scale, orientation, or function before adding unrelated props. One room might be a whole familiar kitchen folded into a harbor wall; another contains only a chair and an intercom.

The player is in a separate constructed refuge containing stolen fragments, not literally still inside an unchanged house. A recovered photograph can confirm the object is theirs. Avoid suggesting that the city cannot have a dining room or a suburb cannot have a TV; the distinction comes from the complete setting.

Some doors welcome you. Some should not.

Initial states and readable uncertainty

Every maze has at least four initially open doors. Open means entry is available, not that the room is safe or its reward is immediately obtainable. Some open rooms require an item at an inner mechanism. Other entrances are locked, sealed, flooded, or hidden. The notebook distinguishes these states after inspection without labeling unexplored rooms "boss" or "death".

Common corridor topology

Each level uses a connected, branching corridor ring. The names below are creator navigation anchors, not floating on-screen directions. Corridors are traversable in either direction and contain no mandatory consumable toll.

Arrival Court (doors 1 + 4) ↔ Upper Bend (door 2) ↔ Outer Walk (door 3) ↔ Lower Court (door 5) ↔ Echo Landing (door 6) ↔ Arrival Court. Lower Court and Echo Landing both connect to Guardian Approach (door 7). Its cleared arena leads to Exit Landing (door 8).

Each door-catalogue page lists the themed local corridor anchor. These are names for the shared anchors above. Interior rooms 1-6 return to their own entrance after success, inspection, or voluntary retreat. Optional door 4 also has a discoverable second exit to Echo Landing. Door 7 must be defeated before its arena exit reaches door 8; its entrance remains usable for backtracking.

Locks and rewards

Required rewards are deterministic on first successful completion, not random drops. A wrong item does nothing and costs no life. Show a silhouette or descriptive clue for the missing object once the door is inspected. Keys remain in the Quest inventory after use; state flags record opened doors. The Dozing Stone remains at its bridge plate as an installed quest item, and the Rope remains anchored; neither is required elsewhere.

Meaning of a perfect route

Minimum-clear route: finish the required tasks without failed attempts. A-H is the eight-action guide. Completion route: also solve optional door 4, collect its item and all story records, then leave. First-time players may enter rooms early, backtrack, fail games, or die. All of those paths must remain recoverable.

Death sends you back to the maze

ON-SCREEN DEATH MESSAGE
You died. You lost 1 life.
Button: Return to maze
Example counter: 5 hearts → 4 hearts

The character dissolves into sparks; no graphic injury. After acknowledgement, respawn at the CURRENT level's maze entrance (Chimney Court, Dry Quay, Ticket Square, or Root Porch). Do not send the player to the previous world or merely to the same room entrance. Doors are not all locked on return.

What persists and what resets

Persist: earned quest items, installed mechanisms, opened locks, solved required puzzles, defeated guardians, collected memories, discovered shortcuts, notebook evidence, and map discoveries.
Reset: current failed puzzle board, guardian health if not yet defeated, hazard positions, and uncollected room reward. A completed unique reward cannot be farmed or duplicated.

Exactly one life loss per failed attempt

Fatal trap or monster contact: death message, minus one heart, return to the maze. Exhausting a scored puzzle's move/attempt allowance: "Challenge failed. You lost 1 life," then return to the maze. Invalid word placement, wrong inventory selection, inspecting a locked door, voluntary retreat, and non-scored story puzzles cost no life. Deduplicate simultaneous hit and timeout events so one failure never deducts twice.

No hearts remaining

At zero hearts, save progress and show "No lives remaining" with time until the next free heart. Starting proposal: five-heart maximum; one heart restored every 20 minutes. Offer wait/return later and the optional refill purchase. No further hazardous-room entry until a heart is available; the player can inspect the notebook, satchel, and cosmetics. Reopening the app must not reset earned progress.

A failed attempt should still teach something

Record the observed warning in the notebook after a death: "The vents flash before they fire." Keep retry routes navigable. Do not randomize a warning after death. A player can lose a life by walking through an open door and triggering its danger, but the door itself should not be an unexplained, unavoidable instant-kill lottery.

The Crooked Kiln

Fire / a deserted pottery town. Leaning chimneys turn toward footsteps. Ovens fire with nobody working, and unfinished clay figures change poses when the player looks away.

Maze location: Chimney Court

K1 / The Missing-Finger Hand [OPEN]
Destination: Potter's Cupboard Access: No item needed.
Inside: A soot-blackened handprint has four fingers. Inspect the mitts and the four-fingered statue beside them; no scored game.
Reward / next use: Potter's Mitts; operate K2's hot lever.

Maze location: Mould Lane

K2 / The Clay-Toothed Gear [OPEN]
Destination: Crooked Pump Shop Access: Enter freely; Mitts required at the lever.
Inside: Matching: collect 12 ember fragments in 10 moves. Words: arrange EMBER from a supplied clue and tiles. The repaired pump releases a drawer.
Reward / next use: Little Tooth Key; opens the cache in K3.

Maze location: Flue Walk

K3 / The Glowing Clawmarks [OPEN / HAZARD]
Destination: Breathing Flue Access: Enter freely. Little Tooth Key opens the reward cache.
Inside: Cross three vent lanes using flash-and-hiss warnings. Pip offers a slower hazard assist. Entering early is possible, but touching a live vent is fatal.
Reward / next use: Emberglass Lens from the keyed cache; reveals K5's latch.

Maze location: Chimney Court

K4 / The Downward Chimney [OPEN / OPTIONAL]
Destination: Borrowed Sitting Room Access: No item needed.
Inside: A familiar chair and a chimney sucking smoke downward lure the player into a loop. Read the reflection to find a second exit. Ignoring floor cracks can cause a fatal fall.
Reward / next use: A Brass Button collectible; optional exit to Stitch Landing. No quest key here.

Failure rule: any scored puzzle loss or fatal hazard sends the player to Chimney Court with one fewer heart. Inspection and safe retreat are free. Required rewards are granted once, only after the listed task is completed.

The Crooked Kiln

Every required object is obtainable through play. Locked entrances do not consume a life when inspected.

Maze location: Glaze Court

K5 / The Stitched Eye [SEALED]
Destination: Blind Glazer's Room Access: Emberglass Lens reveals the hidden latch.
Inside: Matching: clear two soot seals in 12 moves. Words: use the revealed marks to select COOL rather than COAL, then enter COOL. Threads loosen around a mechanical eye.
Reward / next use: Crooked-Tooth Cog; repairs K7's entrance mechanism.

Maze location: Stitch Landing

K6 / The Red Thread [OPEN / STORY]
Destination: Room Behind the Stitch Access: Enter freely. Full message is revealed after K5 is solved.
Inside: Inspect the companion's origin-specific trace. The thread taps three slow beats, then one quick beat. No scored game; record automatically.
Reward / next use: Smith rhythm recorded; required alongside the Cog at K7.

Maze location: Furnace Approach

K7 / The Stapled Circle [LOCKED / GUARDIAN]
Destination: The Cinder Smith's Foundry Access: Crooked-Tooth Cog + recorded Smith rhythm.
Inside: Set the entrance rhythm, then cool three seals and bait the hammer onto them. No simultaneous board puzzle and dodging. A direct hammer hit is fatal.
Reward / next use: Kiln Key; opens K8. Guardian victory is permanent.

Maze location: Cooling Landing

K8 / The Steaming Wave [LOCKED / EXIT]
Destination: The Long Cooling Passage Access: Kiln Key.
Inside: Open the lock and follow the corridor. No new paid or timed task. Transition scene triggers once on crossing.
Reward / next use: Arrival at Upside-Down Harbor; new maze entrance saved.

Failure rule: any scored puzzle loss or fatal hazard sends the player to Chimney Court with one fewer heart. Inspection and safe retreat are free. Required rewards are granted once, only after the listed task is completed.

The Crooked Kiln / the way through

Corridor ring: Chimney Court ↔ Mould Lane ↔ Flue Walk ↔ Glaze Court ↔ Stitch Landing ↔ Chimney Court. From Glaze Court or Stitch Landing, reach Furnace Approach (door 7); its cleared arena leads to Cooling Landing (door 8).

A Arrival | B K1 | C K2 | D K3
E K5 | F K6 | G K7 | H K8

A. Arrive in Chimney Court; inspect the maze map and lantern.

B. K1: take the Potter's Mitts.

C. K2: operate the hot lever; win the puzzle; take the Little Tooth Key.

D. K3: survive the vents; open the cache; take the Emberglass Lens.

E. K5: reveal the latch; solve the seals; take the Crooked-Tooth Cog.

F. K6: inspect the trace and record the Smith rhythm.

G. K7: install the Cog and rhythm; defeat the Cinder Smith; take the Kiln Key.

H. K8: unlock the passage; trigger the scene; enter Upside-Down Harbor.

Other obtainable routes

Completion route: K1 → K2 → K3 → K4 → K5 → K6 → K7 → K8. Door 4 grants its collectible and can shorten a later corridor walk; it never replaces a required object.
Early exploration: K6 can be visited before K5, but only a faint tapping is heard. Return after K5; the full rhythm is then recorded. No early visit creates an invalid flag.
After death: return to Chimney Court; use the notebook to walk to the earliest unfinished required door. Solved tasks are not replayed for their unique reward.

Origin layer / same mechanics

City: A radiator ticks inside a clay oven; your apartment chair stands on a roof; soot outlines the TV stand.
Midwest: Barn boards brace the kilns; the feed scoop is embedded in clay; corn leaves protrude from the chimneys.
Suburbs: Dining chairs stand on mismatched pedestals; the patio-door frame surrounds a furnace; a garage remote clicks by itself.

Exit scene / first crossing only

Companion trace: City: a child's drawing of your chair with the note, "It remembered the room wrong." Farm: pawprints beside the dog's familiar blanket, dragged toward a passage. Suburb: a place card in your partner's handwriting: "Our table is here. We aren't home."

Warden: "Those things followed you. Familiar surroundings can be a comfort."

Pip: "Then why was that chair dusty before we arrived?"

Trigger: K8 crossed successfully. Pause lantern timers; save the next arrival after the scene. Skipping the scene adds its transcript to the notebook. For the dog, traces and actions communicate the message; the dog does not write dialogue.

Upside-Down Harbor

Water / a port assembled at impossible angles. Boats hang overhead. Water carries furniture along streets, tide marks climb ceilings, and windows look into rooms turned sideways.

Maze location: Dry Quay

H1 / The Weeping Bowl [OPEN]
Destination: Dry-Dock Pantry Access: No item needed.
Inside: A cracked bowl holds a moving drop. Search the shelves and inspect a wheel shaped like a smiling ship's face. No scored game.
Reward / next use: Ship's Smile Wheel; operates H2's sluice.

Maze location: Mooring Bend

H2 / The Backward Spiral [OPEN]
Destination: Inside-Out Sluice Access: Enter freely; Wheel required at the mechanism.
Inside: Matching: move a bubble token through a 6-by-6 board in 14 moves. Words: restore FLOW from a sluice diagram, then choose the outlet marked in the note.
Reward / next use: Archive Drained flag; H3 becomes accessible.

Maze location: Archive Walk

H3 / The Fish-Pressed Book [FLOODED / GATED]
Destination: Lower Archive Access: H2 must drain the entrance.
Inside: Follow marked shelves between predictable water surges. A tide record reveals the dry recovery alcoves. Missing shelter during a surge is fatal.
Reward / next use: Brass Gillfish; unfolds into a magical breathing aid for H5.

Maze location: Dry Quay

H4 / The Climbing Footprints [OPEN / OPTIONAL]
Destination: The Floating Supper Access: No item needed.
Inside: Familiar voices come from a table above a current. The visible return rope leads out; releasing it at a warning swirl is fatal. Inspect the side alcove for a collectible.
Reward / next use: Bent Teaspoon collectible; rope shortcut from Dry Quay to Watcher Landing.

Failure rule: any scored puzzle loss or fatal hazard sends the player to Dry Quay with one fewer heart. Inspection and safe retreat are free. Required rewards are granted once, only after the listed task is completed.

Upside-Down Harbor

Every required object is obtainable through play. Locked entrances do not consume a life when inspected.

Maze location: Glass Court

H5 / The Caged Bubble [WATER-SEAL]
Destination: Air-Pocket Cabinet Access: Brass Gillfish opens the fish-shaped water seal.
Inside: Swim the short marked approach, then solve safely in an air pocket. Matching: collect 10 pearl tokens in 12 moves. Words: solve PEARL from the illustrated clue.
Reward / next use: Pearlglass Eye; reads cloudy glass at H6.

Maze location: Watcher Landing

H6 / The Wrong-Tide Window [OPEN / STORY]
Destination: The Watcher's Booth Access: Enter freely; Pearlglass Eye reveals the full inscription.
Inside: Read an altered passenger list and the companion trace. Three symbols identify the floodgate order. No scored attempt; save the clue automatically.
Reward / next use: Low-Tide Sequence; opens H7's gate controls.

Maze location: Tower Approach

H7 / The Bitten Ring [LOCKED / GUARDIAN]
Destination: Undertow Tower Access: Low-Tide Sequence recorded at H6.
Inside: Set the entry valves, then open three floodgates during the Undertow's recovery pauses. A signaled rush can sweep the player away; fatal on contact.
Reward / next use: Harbor Key; opens H8.

Maze location: Cold Landing

H8 / The Dripping Feather [LOCKED / EXIT]
Destination: The Cold Stair Access: Harbor Key.
Inside: The final lock opens onto stairs where droplets stop in midair. Transition scene occurs before the next arrival.
Reward / next use: Arrival at The Midnight Snowfair.

Failure rule: any scored puzzle loss or fatal hazard sends the player to Dry Quay with one fewer heart. Inspection and safe retreat are free. Required rewards are granted once, only after the listed task is completed.

Upside-Down Harbor / the way through

Corridor ring: Dry Quay ↔ Mooring Bend ↔ Archive Walk ↔ Glass Court ↔ Watcher Landing ↔ Dry Quay. From Glass Court or Watcher Landing, reach Tower Approach (door 7); its cleared arena leads to Cold Landing (door 8).

A Arrival | B H1 | C H2 | D H3
E H5 | F H6 | G H7 | H H8

A. Arrive at Dry Quay; see your familiar object floating above the street.

B. H1: collect the Ship's Smile Wheel.

C. H2: fit the Wheel; solve the sluice puzzle; drain the archive.

D. H3: enter the archive; avoid surges; recover the Brass Gillfish.

E. H5: pass the water seal; solve the cabinet puzzle; take the Pearlglass Eye.

F. H6: reveal the passenger list; record the Low-Tide Sequence.

G. H7: set the valves; defeat the Undertow; take the Harbor Key.

H. H8: unlock the Cold Stair; trigger the scene; enter The Midnight Snowfair.

Other obtainable routes

Completion route: H1 → H2 → H3 → H4 → H5 → H6 → H7 → H8. Door 4 grants its collectible and can shorten a later corridor walk; it never replaces a required object.
Early exploration: H6 can be inspected early, but its inscription remains unreadable until the Pearlglass Eye is owned. H3 shows visible floodwater before H2; trying its door costs nothing.
After death: return to Dry Quay; use the notebook to walk to the earliest unfinished required door. Solved tasks are not replayed for their unique reward.

Origin layer / same mechanics

City: The kitchen chair is caught in a flooded corridor; apartment windows hang beneath a boat; an intercom repeats an unfinished sentence.
Midwest: A barn door floats horizontally; corn rows grow beneath the surface; a familiar feed bucket acts as an air bell.
Suburbs: The dining table is attached sideways to a wall; fence panels form a pier; a patio chair rocks on the ceiling.

Exit scene / first crossing only

Companion trace: City: a drawing on dry glass says, "He asked which window was ours." Farm: the collar tag chimes from a high ledge; beside it, the dog has scratched a gap under a wall. Suburb: your partner writes, "He knew where we sat. He didn't know our names."

Warden: "Rooms are easier to save than people. I am doing what I can."

Pip: "That passenger list calls everyone a replacement. Including you."

Trigger: H8 crossed successfully. Pause lantern timers; save the next arrival after the scene. Skipping the scene adds its transcript to the notebook. For the dog, traces and actions communicate the message; the dog does not write dialogue.

The Midnight Snowfair

Ice / a winter fair that never finishes. Frozen rides play half a melody. Snow sculptures shift between visits, and prize stalls display ordinary belongings as though someone won them.

Maze location: Ticket Square

F1 / The Borrowed Bootprint [OPEN]
Destination: Lost-Coat Booth Access: No item needed.
Inside: A tiny footprint sits within a giant one. Inspect a coat rack and a pair of patched winter shoes. No scored challenge.
Reward / next use: Fairground Grippers; stop on marked rough ice in F2.

Maze location: Sled Bend

F2 / The Returning Arrow [OPEN / HAZARD]
Destination: The Sled Gallery Access: Enter freely; Grippers required to stop at the reward alcove.
Inside: Slide through a readable route with marked barriers. Without Grippers, a safe side exit returns to the maze; ignoring a cracked edge causes a fatal fall.
Reward / next use: Laughing Mirror Sliver; operates F3's light puzzle.

Maze location: Mirror Walk

F3 / The Curtained Sun [OPEN]
Destination: The Lantern Carousel Access: Enter freely; Mirror Sliver needed at the receiver.
Inside: Matching: clear three frost seals in 14 moves. Words: solve THAW and set the beam toward the clue-marked prize. Work from a stationary platform.
Reward / next use: Sleeping Sun; melts F5's ice seal.

Maze location: Ticket Square

F4 / The Shared Shadow [OPEN / OPTIONAL]
Destination: The Laughing Reflection Hall Access: No item needed.
Inside: Two carved faces share one shadow. The obvious reflected exit loops back. A reflection missing its scarf marks a hidden side door; cracked ice warns of a fatal pit.
Reward / next use: Clockwork Ticket collectible; safe discovered shortcut to Listening Landing.

Failure rule: any scored puzzle loss or fatal hazard sends the player to Ticket Square with one fewer heart. Inspection and safe retreat are free. Required rewards are granted once, only after the listed task is completed.

The Midnight Snowfair

Every required object is obtainable through play. Locked entrances do not consume a life when inspected.

Maze location: Prize Alley

F5 / The Burned Snowflake [ICE-SEALED]
Destination: The Prizekeeper's Nursery Access: Sleeping Sun.
Inside: Wake the Sun, melt the seal, and inspect the unfinished family scene. A simple non-scored picture assembly reveals a drawer. Wrong placements cost no life.
Reward / next use: Prizekeeper Key; unlocks F7, plus a story record about the first lost family.

Maze location: Listening Landing

F6 / The Crooked Star [OPEN / STORY]
Destination: The Listening Booth Access: Enter freely. The full companion trace appears after F5.
Inside: Listen to a reversed fairground tune, then inspect the written/visual version. It reveals that the real owl alone casts a shadow.
Reward / next use: Owl Shadow Clue; required with Prizekeeper Key at F7.

Maze location: Owl Approach

F7 / The Scratched Perch [LOCKED / GUARDIAN]
Destination: The Glass Owl's Observatory Access: Prizekeeper Key + Owl Shadow Clue.
Inside: Choose the real owl by its shadow and redirect three beams into perch seals. A charging owl is fatal; a clearly marked shelter provides a safe pause.
Reward / next use: Snowfair Key; opens F8.

Maze location: Hatch Landing

F8 / The Leafless Crack [LOCKED / EXIT]
Destination: The Buried Service Tunnel Access: Snowfair Key.
Inside: The key releases a frozen hatch. Descend past roots pushing through the ice; scene plays on crossing.
Reward / next use: Arrival at The Buried Orchard.

Failure rule: any scored puzzle loss or fatal hazard sends the player to Ticket Square with one fewer heart. Inspection and safe retreat are free. Required rewards are granted once, only after the listed task is completed.

The Midnight Snowfair / the way through

Corridor ring: Ticket Square ↔ Sled Bend ↔ Mirror Walk ↔ Prize Alley ↔ Listening Landing ↔ Ticket Square. From Prize Alley or Listening Landing, reach Owl Approach (door 7); its cleared arena leads to Hatch Landing (door 8).

A Arrival | B F1 | C F2 | D F3
E F5 | F F6 | G F7 | H F8

A. Arrive in Ticket Square; hear a familiar household sound inside the fair's music.

B. F1: collect the Fairground Grippers.

C. F2: solve the sliding route; take the Laughing Mirror Sliver.

D. F3: fit the Sliver; solve the light puzzle; receive the Sleeping Sun.

E. F5: melt the seal; assemble the picture; take the Prizekeeper Key.

F. F6: inspect the complete trace and record the Owl Shadow Clue.

G. F7: use the Key and clue; defeat the Glass Owl; take the Snowfair Key.

H. F8: open the hatch; trigger the scene; descend into The Buried Orchard.

Other obtainable routes

Completion route: F1 → F2 → F3 → F4 → F5 → F6 → F7 → F8. Door 4 grants its collectible and can shorten a later corridor walk; it never replaces a required object.
Early exploration: F6 is safe to visit early but holds only an incomplete melody until F5. F2 is enterable without the shoes, with a free return exit; no item is obtainable from its reward alcove yet.
After death: return to Ticket Square; use the notebook to walk to the earliest unfinished required door. Solved tasks are not replayed for their unique reward.

Origin layer / same mechanics

City: Your sofa is frozen inside a prize booth; an apartment radiator warms a patch of ice; the TV remote appears among the tickets.
Midwest: Corn forms a frozen hedge maze; barn rafters support the carousel; a familiar porch blanket covers an unfinished sculpture.
Suburbs: Dining place settings sit on the carousel; a garage door becomes a prize shutter; fence posts hold strings of fair lights.

Exit scene / first crossing only

Companion trace: City: the child's drawing gives your chair a door and says, "I left you an exit." Farm: pawprints cross the family scene and lead away; the dog has pulled a curtain aside to expose a latch. Suburb: the partner's place card reads, "Don't tell him what you remember."

Warden: "I built a place where nothing precious had to disappear. Why does everyone insist on leaving?"

Pip: "Look at the dates. He has been rebuilding the same evening for years."

Trigger: F8 crossed successfully. Pause lantern timers; save the next arrival after the scene. Skipping the scene adds its transcript to the notebook. For the dog, traces and actions communicate the message; the dog does not write dialogue.

The Buried Orchard

Earth / a village growing underneath itself. Roots run through bedrooms, rooftops sit below floors, and fallen fruit rolls uphill toward the original room at the center of the refuge.

Maze location: Root Porch

O1 / The Fraying Weight [OPEN]
Destination: The Drowsy Weighhouse Access: No item needed.
Inside: Matching: collect 12 stone tokens in 12 moves. Words: solve HEAVY from an illustrated scale clue. Release a sleeping, face-carved counterweight.
Reward / next use: Dozing Stone; holds O2's bridge plate.

Maze location: Rooftop Bend

O2 / The Root-Split Bridge [OPEN]
Destination: The Upside-Up Crossing Access: Enter freely; Dozing Stone holds the bridge stable.
Inside: Place the Stone and cross. A half-raised section blocks progress safely without it. Rushing onto a shaking side plank can cause a fatal fall.
Reward / next use: Knotwake Rope; living vine used at O3.

Maze location: Hanging Walk

O3 / The Knotted Face [OPEN / HAZARD]
Destination: The Hanging Rootshaft Access: Enter freely; Knotwake Rope needed at the marked anchor.
Inside: Span the gap, then cross while watching dust warnings from above. A safe ledge permits retreat; a boulder strike is fatal.
Reward / next use: Bellhead Hammer; locates O5's hollow latch.

Maze location: Root Porch

O4 / The Empty Nest Hand [OPEN / OPTIONAL]
Destination: The Offering Room Access: No item needed.
Inside: A gnarled hand requests the keepsake. The player can refuse or place it temporarily, exposing records of past captives; it is always returned. Unsafe branches show splitting bark.
Reward / next use: Wooden Nest collectible and an optional past-captive record; a root lift exits at Portrait Landing.

Failure rule: any scored puzzle loss or fatal hazard sends the player to Root Porch with one fewer heart. Inspection and safe retreat are free. Required rewards are granted once, only after the listed task is completed.

The Buried Orchard

Every required object is obtainable through play. Locked entrances do not consume a life when inspected.

Maze location: Bell Court

O5 / The Bell in Stone [HIDDEN LATCH]
Destination: The Singing Wall Access: Bellhead Hammer.
Inside: Strike three marked panels to locate the hollow one. Matching: collect three sound-token sets in 15 moves. Words: solve RING, then order the tones shown by the carvings.
Reward / next use: Orchard Seal; also Revealed Original Room flag for O6.

Maze location: Portrait Landing

O6 / The Turned Portrait [HIDDEN / STORY]
Destination: The Original Room Access: O5 must expose the route.
Inside: Inspect the refuge builder's family records and the companion's altered escape diagram. The guide is the builder himself. No scored puzzle.
Reward / next use: Homeward Sequence; necessary at O8. This is the central story reveal.

Maze location: Foundation Approach

O7 / The Strangled Circle [LOCKED / GUARDIAN]
Destination: The Rootkeeper's Foundation Access: Orchard Seal.
Inside: Lure stomps onto three marked plates and strike the revealed resonant stones. The Hammer remains owned and usable. Stomp contact is fatal.
Reward / next use: Orchard Key; required at O8.

Maze location: Homeward Landing

O8 / The Scratched Handle [LOCKED / FINALE]
Destination: The Companion's Chamber Access: Orchard Key + Homeward Sequence.
Inside: The companion completes the inner latch as the player sets the outer sequence. Opens the final confrontation and escape, not a fifth required world.
Reward / next use: Rescue resolved in the base campaign; complete ending follows.

Failure rule: any scored puzzle loss or fatal hazard sends the player to Root Porch with one fewer heart. Inspection and safe retreat are free. Required rewards are granted once, only after the listed task is completed.

The Buried Orchard / the way through

Corridor ring: Root Porch ↔ Rooftop Bend ↔ Hanging Walk ↔ Bell Court ↔ Portrait Landing ↔ Root Porch. From Bell Court or Portrait Landing, reach Foundation Approach (door 7); its cleared arena leads to Homeward Landing (door 8).

A Arrival | B O1 | C O2 | D O3
E O5 | F O6 | G O7 | H O8

A. Arrive at Root Porch; see pieces of home embedded in the roots.

B. O1: complete the scale puzzle; collect the Dozing Stone.

C. O2: hold the bridge plate; cross; collect Knotwake Rope.

D. O3: anchor the Rope; avoid falling debris; recover the Bellhead Hammer.

E. O5: locate the latch; solve the sound puzzle; take the Orchard Seal.

F. O6: enter the revealed room; learn the truth; record the Homeward Sequence.

G. O7: use the Seal; defeat the Rootkeeper; take the Orchard Key.

H. O8: use the Key and sequence; reunite with the companion; play the finale.

Other obtainable routes

Completion route: O1 → O2 → O3 → O4 → O5 → O6 → O7 → O8. Door 4 grants its collectible and can shorten a later corridor walk; it never replaces a required object.
Early exploration: After O5, O6 and O7 may be completed in either order. O8 stays locked until BOTH the Orchard Key and Homeward Sequence are owned. Earlier objects cannot be sold or destroyed.
After death: return to Root Porch; use the notebook to walk to the earliest unfinished required door. Solved tasks are not replayed for their unique reward.

Origin layer / same mechanics

City: Apartment doors hang from roots; a fire escape becomes a bridge; the familiar chair faces the final door.
Midwest: A grain chute becomes the descent; corn roots bind barn doors; the dog's toy is visible through the final gap.
Suburbs: The dining table stands on its side as a barricade; fence gates form root arches; the dinner mirror frames the final door.

Exit scene / first crossing only

Companion trace: City: the child has drawn the two halves of a latch on opposite sides of the door. Farm: the dog has dug beneath the inner latch and responds to the familiar toy sound. Suburb: your partner taps your shared dinner rhythm against the frame.

Warden: "I kept every room. Every chair. I thought if I put it all back, someone would stay."

Pip: "A home needs a way out. Let them choose."

Trigger: O8 crossed successfully. Pause lantern timers; save the next arrival after the scene. Skipping the scene adds its transcript to the notebook. For the dog, traces and actions communicate the message; the dog does not write dialogue.

The satchel: see what you have and why

Township's official support describes storage expansion through materials and currency, and currency spending on missing goods and puzzle moves [1-2]. Miswander adapts the visible collection-and-use idea into an adventure satchel, with original art, item names, and rules.

Five inventory tabs

Quest: keys, unique tools, installed-item records, and the personal keepsake. Unlimited capacity; no selling or discarding; survives death.
Supplies: Power Cells and optional boosters, shown with quantities. No overflow for purchased items.
Materials: optional crafting supplies, with visible owned/needed counts.
Memories: companion traces and past-captive records; clues also appear in the notebook.
Wardrobe: outfits, lantern shells, pet appearances, and owned companions.

An item card should answer four questions

POTTER'S MITTS / Quest tool / Owned: 1
Scorched, oversized, patched in two different fabrics.
Use: Handle the hot lever in the Crooked Pump Shop.
Found: Missing-Finger Hand door, Chimney Court.
Status after use: retained. Buttons: Inspect / Track known location.

Unknown uses are not spoiled in advance. Before K2 is discovered, say "Protects against hot handles." After inspecting K2, the item card may identify that mechanism. A discovered lock card shows "Need: Potter's Mitts" and a silhouette; no automatic map reveal of undiscovered rooms.

Optional crafting / proposal, not a new story gate

Example: one optional Power Cell requires 2 Glow Shards + 1 Copper Scrap at a recharge bench. After their first clear, K2, K5, H2, H5, F3, O1, and O5 offer optional practice boards: each successful replay alternates 1 shard, then 1 scrap. Unique quest rewards never repeat; practice failure follows the one-life rule. Costs and yields need balance testing. Quest items cannot be ingredients. Capacity proposal: 30 optional-material units, expandable by 10 with 3 scrap + 2 thread; a proposed $1.99 permanent expansion is an alternative, not a required purchase.

If optional-material storage is full, allow sorting, an overflow claim tray, or exchanging surplus. Never destroy rewards or block a required key. Show quantities, recipes, sources, and the free route before offering a purchase. Do not add waits to every lock; the A-H route has no crafting or storage purchase requirement.

Purchases tied to the adventure

Illustrative U.S. dollar proposals only; these are not Township prices or tested revenue forecasts. Actual localized prices and store terms must be configured and checked before launch. Keep one earnable/purchasable Power Cell supply rather than several overlapping paid currencies.

Power Cells / proposed $0.99

One cell adds five minutes of bright lantern light in optional dark branches. Timer pauses during puzzles, reading, menus, purchases, and cutscenes. Depletion leaves a dim return-path glow. Free recharge: proposed 20-minute wait or optional challenge/crafting reward. Cells do not unlock required story doors.

Clothing and companions

Outfit $1.99; four-outfit set $5.99; lantern shell $0.99; pet companion $2.99; specified outfit-and-pet duo $3.99. Ideas: clay-patched kiln jacket, harbor raincoat, snowfair cape, orchard workwear; ember fox, pearl otter, snow owl, moss turtle. Give all players a basic guide/companion. Cosmetic purchases do not change guardian strength.

Lives and puzzle help

Five-heart refill $0.99 if the five-heart model is retained. Matching toolkit $0.99: one line clear, one tile hammer, one voluntary reshuffle; dead-board reshuffles are free. Word clue kit $0.99: three hint tokens revealing a letter or highlighting already-discovered evidence. Do not invent unseen evidence or require a purchase for the answer.

Materials and satchel upgrades

Optional recipe top-up $0.99 with exact contents displayed, for example 2 shards + 1 scrap. Permanent materials expansion +10 units for $1.99 as an alternative to earned upgrades. Quest storage remains unlimited. Purchases exceeding current material capacity go to an unlimited claim tray. Bundle contents must not silently duplicate owned permanent items.

New play after the rescue

Ten-room puzzle pack $1.99; five-stage side case $2.99; complete new-world adventure $4.99. Each pack has its own ending. A paid seasonal reward track is a later option only if new content can be delivered reliably; do not launch a subscription by default.

Township references / checked October 28, 2026:
[1] Playrix, "My barn is full": playrix.helpshift.com/hc/en/3-township/faq/130-my-barn-is-full/
[2] Playrix, "Township-cash": playrix.helpshift.com/hc/en/3-township/faq/14960-township-cash/
Borrow the collection, progress visibility, and optional convenience principles; build original screens and a smaller economy suited to this maze adventure.

Bring them home. Leave one mystery open.

The ending / after O8

The companion opens the inner latch. The Warden arrives as familiar objects slide into place around an imitation of the original family room. He asks the player to stay: "It could be right this time." The player recognizes that the room is assembled from other people's lives. Pip exposes a route marked by the earlier companion traces.

The escape reuses learned interactions in a short, checkpointed sequence: cool a handle, redirect a flow, identify a real shadow, and strike a resonant latch. It requires no new consumables, purchases, or surprise fifth key. The Warden can choose to release the final catch; he remains accountable for the captives. The player and companion return through their original portal. Other captives are shown finding exits.

Reunion: TV-night high-five in the apartment; the dog drops its toy on the farmhouse porch; the partner resets the dinner places. One small object remains changed. Later, the portal briefly shows a different place asking for help. This is a sequel hook, not an unpaid portion of the promised rescue.

Verification completed for this design document

32 unique door IDs; eight per environment. Each minimum-clear A-H reward chain is ordered without a circular dependency. Door 4 rewards are never needed for a required exit. Orchard permits O6/O7 in either order, but O8 requires both rewards. Every level includes initially open rooms. Both title artworks are included; no Heart Lantern restoration premise is used.

Meaningful checks for John's eventual build

1. Start with no quest items and follow each A-H route: every required reward must be obtainable.
2. Enter all initially open hazard rooms early: each must allow a free retreat or a warned risk, with no soft lock.
3. Die before and after acquiring each quest item: lose exactly one life, respawn at that level's entrance, retain granted progress.
4. Repeat a solved room: no duplicate quest rewards; no requirement to repay or replay it.
5. Reach O8 with only the key or only the sequence: remain locked, with accurate feedback.
6. Fill optional-material storage: quest acquisition and purchased-supply delivery still work.
7. Switch each origin overlay: the mechanics, reward IDs, and route remain identical.
8. Skip a cutscene, close the app, and resume: restore the correct arrival and notebook transcript.

These are design-level checks, not a claim that a playable game or all puzzle boards have been implemented or tested. Room geometry, board generation, hazard timings, economy balance, and save behavior require prototype validation. Character roster illustrations and a final visual UI specification are separate future deliverables.